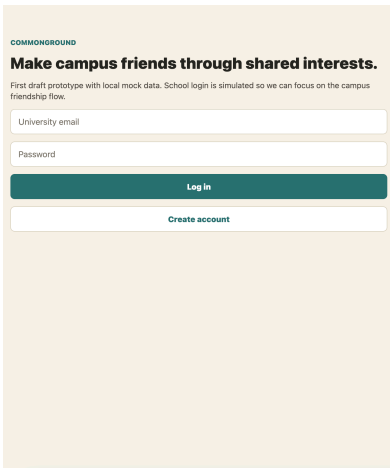
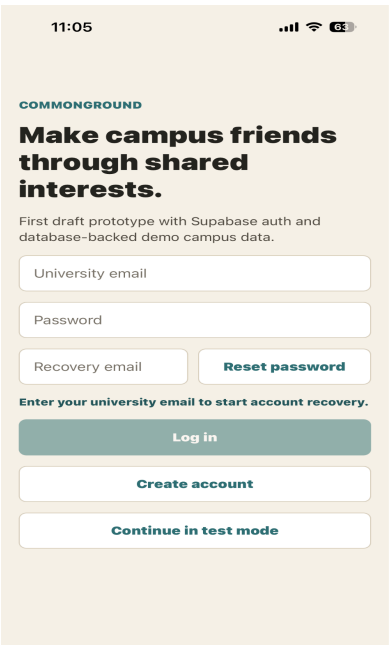


HW 3 -UI

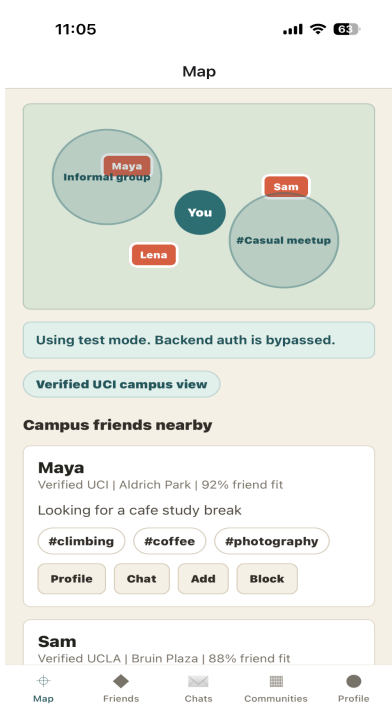
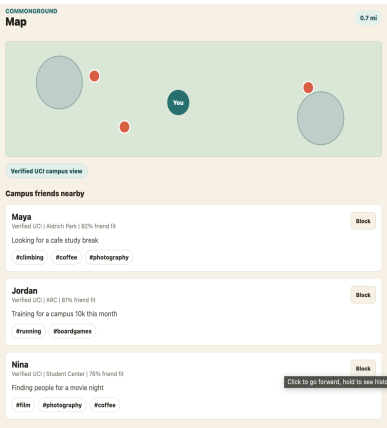
README: This doc shows the iterative design process of our app, in table format.

Part 1: The original screenshot shows earlier versions of our UI while the updated column shows screenshots of the final app. The first column describes how the user should be interacting with the UI.

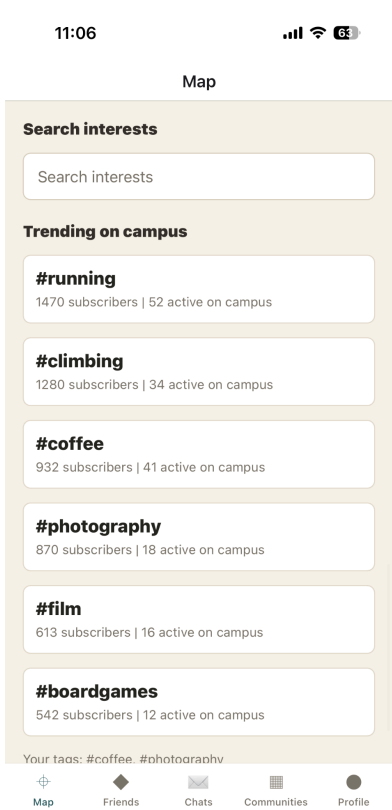
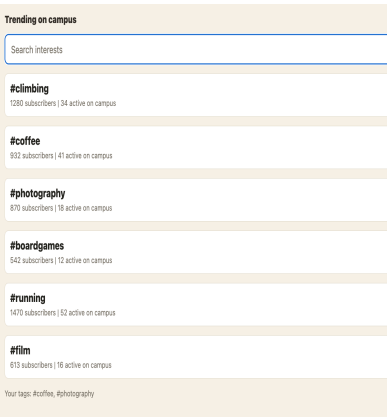
Part 2: There are 10 rows in the table for 10 instances of the Nielsen's Principles. By reading the table from left to right, you can observe how following the neilson's principles guided us in improving our UI implementation.

DESCRIPTION / NEILSON PRINCIPLE	ORIGINAL	UPDATED
Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors: The login screen should contain a <i>forgot password</i> field in order to help users to recover or reset their account in case of any common password related issues occurring.	 The original login screen for 'COMMONGROUND' has a title 'Make campus friends through shared interests.' and a subtitle 'First draft prototype with local mock data. School login is simulated so we can focus on the campus friendship flow.' It features two input fields: 'University email' and 'Password'. Below these is a dark green 'Log in' button and a white 'Create account' button.	 The updated login screen for 'COMMONGROUND' has the same title and subtitle. It features three input fields: 'University email', 'Password', and 'Recovery email'. The 'Recovery email' field is accompanied by a 'Reset password' button. Below the input fields is a prompt 'Enter your university email to start account recovery.' followed by a dark green 'Log in' button, a white 'Create account' button, and a white 'Continue in test mode' button.

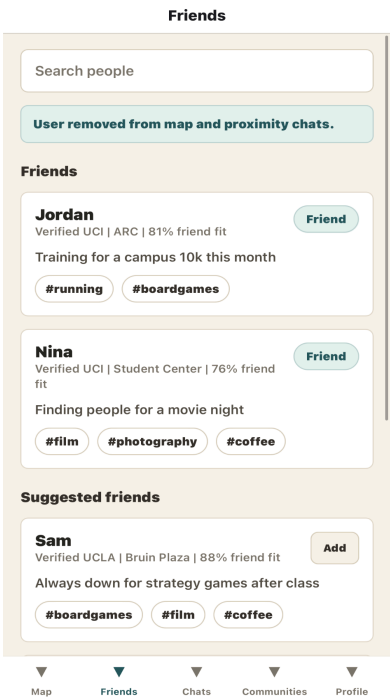
Match Between System and the Real World: The small red dots on the map are not labeled to explain their meaning. Users cannot determine whether they represent individuals, groups, or something else. In real-world maps, the markers usually include names or icons to convey meaning. Each small dot should display an icon or name when clicked, which better aligns with users' expectations of a map in reality.



Visibility of System Status: Wording of this tab is a little ambiguous, supposedly indicates this is a trending on campus category, but allows you to search, letting the user wonder if it's limited to what's trending at the moment. A better indicator would be to either separate the search from the trending, labeling the tab "Search interests" instead and labeling "Trending on campus" just above the suggestions.

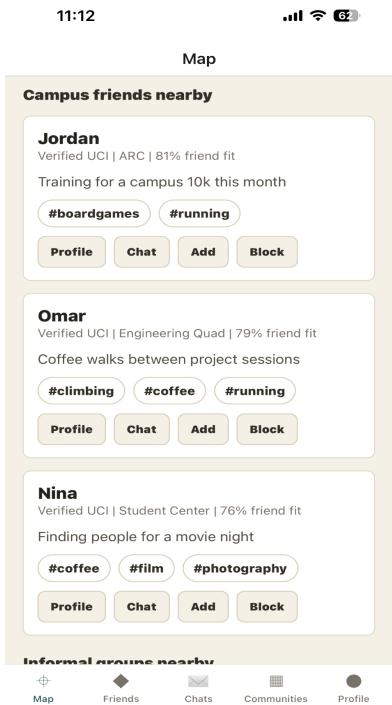
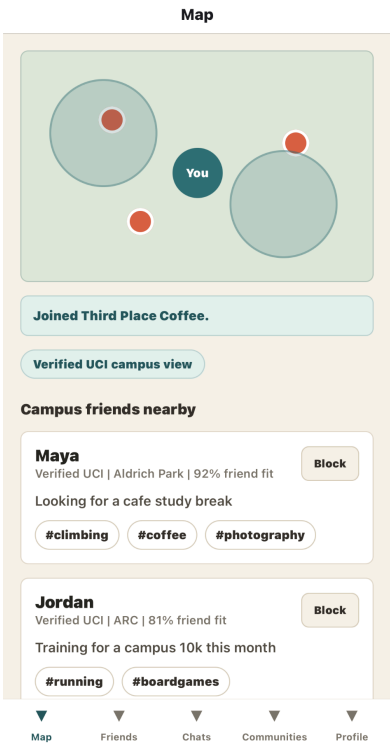


Visibility of System Status: The message “User removed from map and proximity chats” in the notification bar will remain displayed on multiple pages (chat and friend list). Users cannot determine whether this is a temporary message or a persistent system status. This notification should automatically disappear after a few seconds to indicate that this is a status update, rather than remaining at the top all the time.

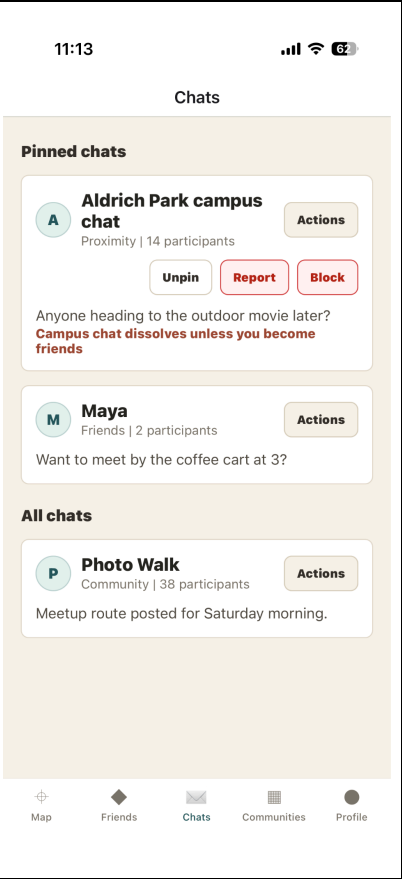
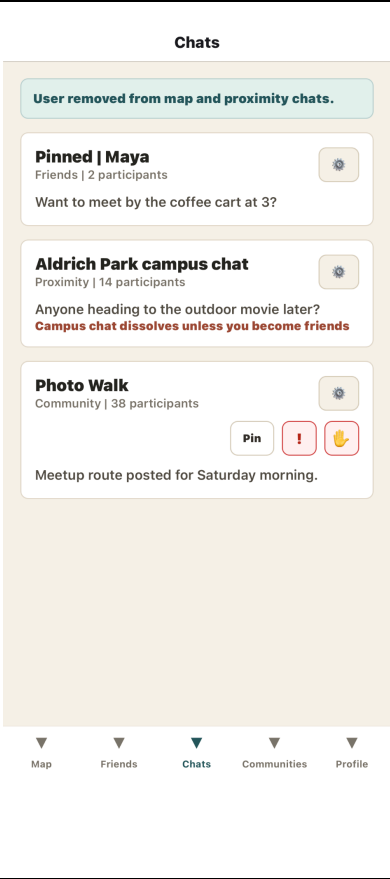


Unable to show this change in a screenshot. However the UI was changed so that the popup fades after several seconds

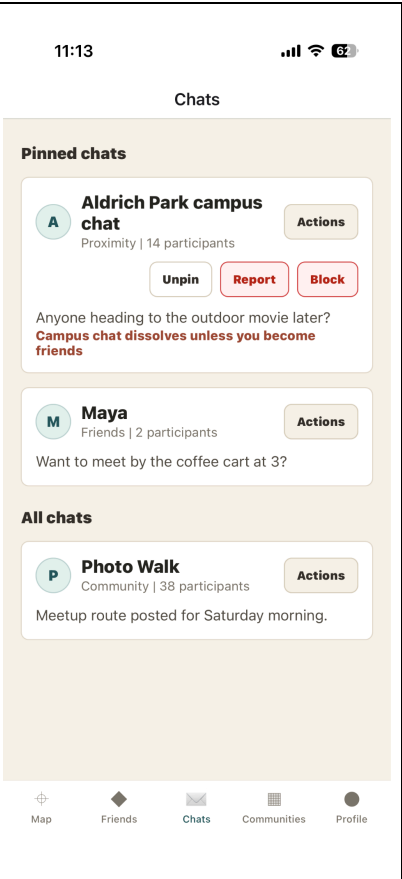
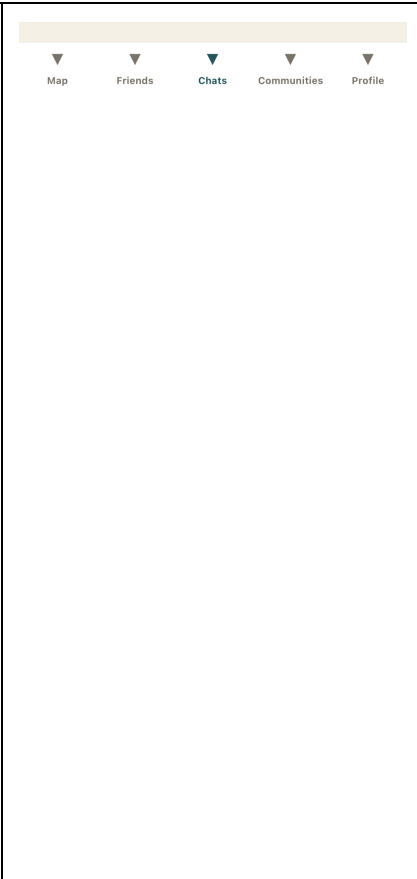
User Control and Freedom: The Campus friends nearby list on the Map screen shows a Block button for the very first section. There is no option to start a chat, add a friend, or view a profile. This limits users to a single negative action and removes their freedom to initiate positive interactions.



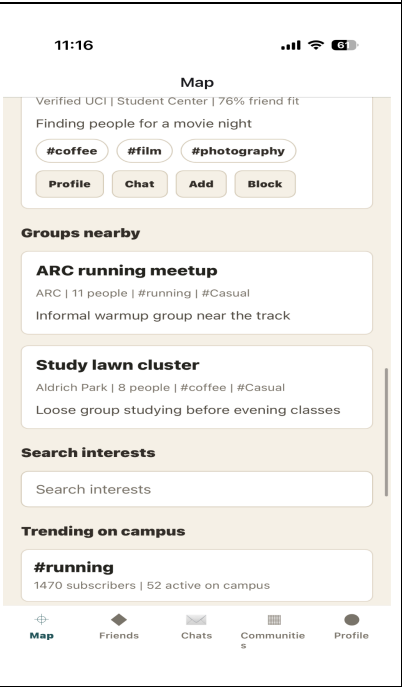
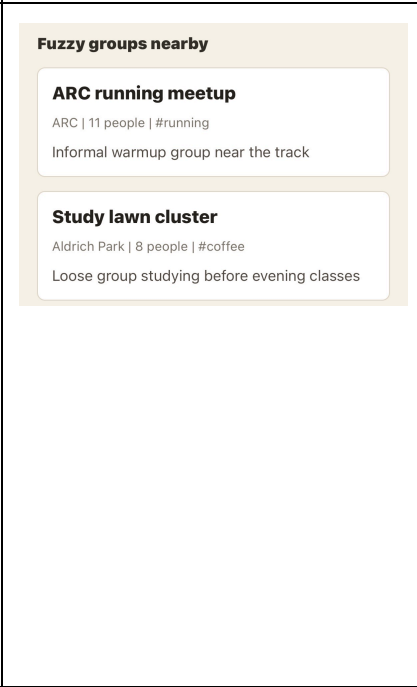
Consistency and Standards: In the chats section, there's a setting emoji. When user clicked it, three buttons will appear: "Pin", "!" and "👉". This inconsistency makes it unclear what the emoji buttons do, especially like 👉, which might be considered to block, wave, etc. All action buttons should use a consistent style with text labels or universally recognized icons.



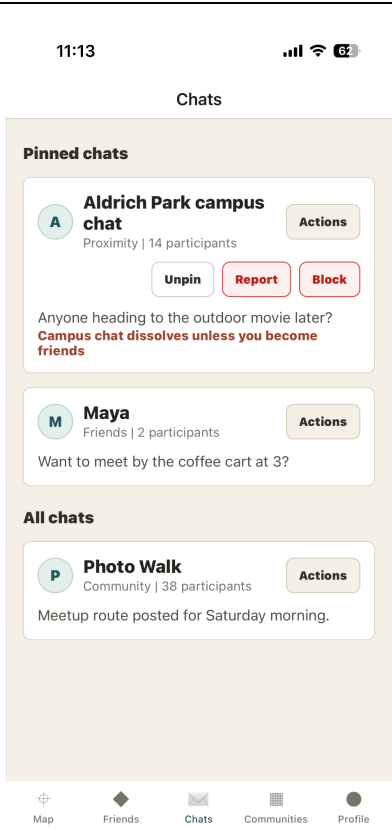
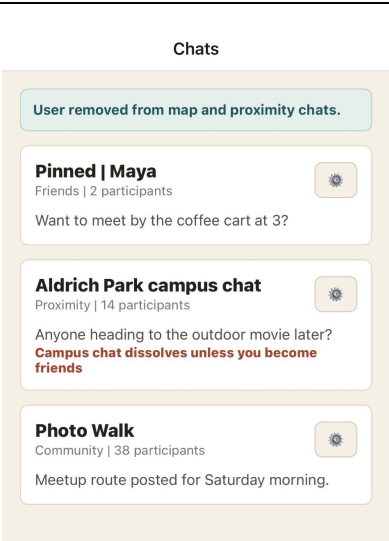
Recognition Rather Than Recall: The navigation bar uses identical downward-pointing triangles for all five sections. There’s no visual distinction between tabs, users have to recognize by reading the text. Navigation bars should use unique, recognizable icons for each tab so users can identify their current location at a glance.



Match Between System and the Real World: The term “fuzzy groups” may be confusing for the user, though you can perhaps infer what it means through the description of the groups underneath, without it, it would be up to the user to decide if it perhaps relates to animal loving interests, or something else. Perhaps a better term would be “Informal Groups Nearby” as one description suggests, or add a tag with “#Casual” on it in order to distinguish these groups.



Recognition Rather Than Recall/Consistency and Standards: Typically, within chatting services or any social media app such as this one, there would be icons or profile pictures uploaded by either the user or the correspondent in order to distinguish themselves from others. Having no profile picture relies on the user to remember each individual by name. It would be also very beneficial for groups to be able to do this as well, as there may be many similar interest groups that one person is in. Slight nitpick as well is for pinning users, perhaps it would be better to create a separate category or just use a pin icon, so the word “Pinned” doesn’t come before the actual user.



Note, adding images to the database was deemed out of scope for this project, so this plan didn’t end up being implemented. However the **Pinned** nitpick was fixed.

Consistency and Standards/Flexibility and Efficiency of Use: As there is a search bar and suggested within the “Friends” tab of the app, there should also be one for communities aside from the suggested on the map tab, as suggested friends are also located there. This will help users navigate without having to scroll through every community for the one they’re looking for. There should also be a separation between joined and suggested.

